

Ojasv Issar

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Summary

Data Scientist & AI/ML Engineer with 4+ years of experience shipping production ML, currently building the **AI models** behind Vintality's precision-viticulture platform; MDS, UBC (4.00/4.00 GPA). End-to-end across **LLM & RAG** systems, NLP, computer vision and scalable data pipelines, from prototype to **deployed endpoint on AWS**: every model ships, every pipeline scales.

Professional Experience

Vintality: Tech + Terroir

Apr. 2026 – Present

Data Scientist (Contract, Full-time)

British Columbia, Canada (Remote)

- Building the **AI models** behind Vintality's grower-facing dashboard, turning raw vineyard measurements into **decision-ready intelligence** for commercial wineries
- Own **geospatial ML** end to end, from feature engineering on NDVI vigour, electrical-conductivity soil maps and terroir data to training, evaluation and served endpoints

Independent Consultant (Freelance)

May 2022 – Apr. 2026

Data Scientist

Remote

- Delivered **end-to-end ML systems** for 30+ clients, including EdTech platforms **Escalera Technologies** and **TechLearniversity**, spanning deep learning, computer vision, NLP and RAG pipelines
- Fine-tuned **XLM-RoBERTa-large** on 15K+ web-scraped Arabic reviews for multilingual sentiment, **beating the client's in-house F1 baseline**; shipped a **production inference pipeline**
- Engineered CNN/YOLO and transformer NLP models improving accuracy by up to 30%; built **ETL pipelines** with Airflow, Kafka and PySpark on Snowflake, PostgreSQL and Neo4j, with Tableau/Power BI dashboards

Spartan Poker

Jan. 2024 – Jun. 2024

Data Analyst Intern

Gurugram, India

- Designed the company's first **game-theoretic payout model** (50K+ players); built **churn models** cutting attrition up to 30% and **fraud pipelines** improving detection 60% over rule-based systems
- Led the **Snowflake** warehouse migration and **QuickSight** BI rollout, cutting **query latency** by 60%

Key Projects

Grounded AI for Road Maintenance (PavePal, UBC MDS Capstone) | Python, RAG, LLMs, embeddings

Apr. – Jun. 2026

- Built a **RAG system** grounding road-maintenance decisions in **pavement surveys** and **DOT guidelines**; evaluated **retrieval quality** and catalogued **failure modes** before deployment
- Found a **vocabulary gap** general embeddings could not bridge ("alligator cracks" vs. "fatigue cracking") and fixed it with **LLM query expansion** in a **two-stage retriever**

Reddit UBC Reporter (UBC CIC GenAI Hackathon) | AWS Lambda, SAM, Bedrock (Llama, Claude), EventBridge, S3

Nov. 2025

- Built a **serverless, 4-function AWS Lambda pipeline** (fetch, analyze, summarize, email) with **dual-model Bedrock inference**: Llama for categorization, Claude for summarization, dispatching weekly r/UBC digests by **automated email**

Climate Change Forecasting | Python, SVR, Random Forest, Docker, Make, Quarto

Dec. 2025

- Modeled **222 years of Berkeley Earth data (1800–2022)**, comparing **Linear Regression, Random Forest and SVR** on RMSE, MAE and R²; SVR projected **2030 land temperature at ~10.56°C**, about **2°C above the 1951–1980 baseline**

Asteroid Hazard Classification (B.Tech Research) | Python, XGBoost, Random Forest, RFECV

2024

- Classified **958,524 NASA/JPL asteroid records** (~0.2% hazardous) reaching **89% recall at 99.7% precision** (ROC-AUC ~0.99); **RFECV** selected 30 features and **MOID** and **absolute magnitude** emerged as the top hazard predictors

Education

University of British Columbia

Vancouver, BC

Master of Data Science — GPA 4.00/4.00

Sep. 2025 – Jun. 2026

- Graduate Teaching Assistant (CBTF Proctor)**: helped scale the testing facility from **22 to 31 courses** (+41%), **155 to 263 exams** (+70%) and **4,298 to 6,094 students** (+42%) in one term, across **38,000+ exams**

Symbiosis Institute of Technology

Pune, India

B.Tech in Computer Science & Engineering, Honours: Data Science

Aug. 2020 – May 2024

Technical Skills

Languages & Tools: Python, R, SQL, Docker, Git, pytest, AWS (Lambda, S3, Bedrock, SAM)

ML/DL: PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, XGBoost, OpenCV, CNNs, YOLO, Transformers, Vision Transformers

Generative AI: LLMs (Claude, GPT, Llama, Gemini), RAG, Retrieval Evaluation, Vector Search, LangChain, Prompt Engineering

Data & Databases: Airflow, Kafka, PySpark, Snowflake, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Neo4j, FAISS, ChromaDB

Visualization: Tableau, Power BI, QuickSight, Plotly Dash, Shiny, Matplotlib, ggplot2

Publications

SneakerXchange: Enhancing User Experience Through HCI Principles in a Reselling Website (2026)

H. Sharma, O. Issar, A. Agarwal, S. Gonge, D. Vora | *Innovative Computing and Communications*, Springer LNNS, pp. 237–250 | top 15% acceptance